

HIST 127: LATIN AMERICAN HISTORY
Race, Class and Nation in Latin America: An Historical Survey

Spring Semester 2014
Patten University at San Quentin

I n s t r u c t o r s

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C o u r s e M e e t i n g s

Friday and Sunday afternoons, 3:00-5:00pm

C o u r s e D e s c r i p t i o n

This survey of Latin American history briefly examines the colonial period, yet focuses primarily on the modern era since independence. Drawing from primary source documents and the writings of historians, this course explores the role of race, class, and gender in the formation of nations, and considers the ideas of “progress” and “backwardness” or “civilization” and “barbarism” in the political, economic, intellectual, and cultural development of the region. Through a comparative approach, this class aims to provide a broad understanding of the origins and the historical trends shaping modern Latin American states, in particular Brazil, Mexico, Argentina, and Cuba.

I m p o r t a n t D a t e s

The add/drop deadline is **Wednesday, February 5**.

The withdrawal deadline is **Wednesday, March 26**.

C o u r s e O b j e c t i v e s

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. identify and describe key social, cultural, political and economic developments in Latin American history
2. explain the historical context of particular contemporary events and developments in the region; comparing and evaluating various arguments advanced by scholars and developing their own

3. identify the geography of the region including countries, major cities, and important geographic features in order to place temporal events and processes in a spatial context.
4. recognize key aspects of history as a discipline, namely the distinction between primary and secondary sources.
5. relate primary source documents to their historical context and analyze their significance and reliability.
6. produce well-organized and supported theses in argumentative essays through the process of pre-writing, brainstorming, outlining and drafting.
7. produce well-organized and varied sentences in the service of clear paragraphs that develop one major idea.
8. prepare short formal presentations of their own work, and articulate and discuss their own ideas in informal class discussions.

Course Requirements

The following represents the course requirements and the percentage of your grade that each represents.

Participation.	20%
Map Quiz.	10%
Short Essays.	
Take Home Midterm.	15%
Critical Analysis.	15%
Final Paper.	
Rough Draft.	5%
Final Draft.	25%
Final Presentation.	10%

Grading

Grades will be based on the following distribution.

A+ = 97% and above	C+ = 77-79.9%
A = 93-96.9%	C = 73-76.9%
A- = 90-92.9%	C- = 70-72.9%
B+ = 87-89.9%	D+ = 67-69.9%
B = 83-86.9%	D = 63-66.9%
B- = 80-82.9%	D- = 60-62.9%
	Below 60% is a failing grade.

It's important to note that students who earn below a C are not generally considered to have mastered the course material, and it's recommended that those students re-take the class.

Assignments

Students should include their (1) name, (2) the date, and (3) the name of the assignment on all materials that are handed in. Late work **will not be accepted** except in very special circumstances. Due dates for these assignments are listed in the course schedule that follows.

Map Quiz.

Knowing the geography of the region will be crucial for engaging with the material in the course. Because of this, your first assignment will be a quiz on country names, major cities and important geographic features of the region. We'll provide you with a map to study from a week before the quiz with all of the information that you'll need to memorize. The quiz will take place in class, you may not use notes, and you will have approximately 15 minutes to complete the quiz.

Short Essay 1. Take-Home Midterm on the Colonial Period.

To evaluate your understanding of the colonial period in Latin America, your first written assignment will be a series of short-answer essays on various aspects of colonial Latin America. Students will be given 3-5 questions to address, they will have a choice about which to answer. You may consult your notes and readings from the class in answering the questions; however, students may not consult or collaborate with their fellow students or inmates, and may not seek help at study-hall. More details on the take-home midterm will be given when it is assigned.

Short Essay 2. Analyzing a Primary Source.

Working with primary sources is a critical skill for students of history. The second short essay assignment asks students to choose a primary source document from amongst those handed out in class and analyze it critically with reference to its historical significance or relevance to a particular historical debate. More details on the analysis will be given when it is assigned.

Final Essay.

The final essay will provide students with the opportunity to explore in more detail a topic from the course of their choosing. The instructors will provide students with some possible prompts or motivating questions, along with the opportunity to free-write and brainstorm to generate paper ideas. Students will complete a rough draft, receive feedback from instructors on that draft, and have the opportunity to revise and refine the draft before submitting a final. If handwritten, the final paper should be 8-15 pages. If typed, the paper should be between 5 and 9 pages.

Final Presentation.

To give students an opportunity to share their work from the final paper, students will be asked to give a 5-10 minute oral presentation after turning in their final essay. Students should think about how clearly and effectively communicate about their paper, how to engage and retain the attention of their audience, and should invest time in preparing, memorizing, and practicing their talk.

What is class participation?

Participation means coming to class prepared every day, having completed any required readings and assignments listed for that day of class. Participation involves paying attention during class to both the instructor and your fellow students. Participation entails offering your thoughts, answering questions, and posing new ones, yet it also means being respectful of the fact that there are other students in the class who may wish to speak and giving them that opportunity. Engaged and thoughtful listening

is a crucial component of participation. In general, good participation is based on the quality of your contributions to class, *not* the quantity.

Methods of Instruction

Instructor led discussion section (a seminar-style class) will be the primary mode of instruction for this course. This makes it all the more necessary that students come prepared, having completed all assigned readings, in order to participate in discussion, and why participation counts so much towards students' final grades.

In addition to discussion, instructors may also lecture for short intervals. Small group work will also be incorporated during some classes, and instructors will spend significant on-on-one time with students, particularly during the drafting and re-writing process leading up to the submission of the final paper.

Attendance

Students must arrive on-time for all classes, and may not leave early. The only excuse for tardiness is an institutional constraint beyond the student's control. Absences due to the following will be considered excused:

- Institutional lockdowns
- Medical lay-ins or hospitalizations
- Court dates
- Administrative segregation
- Religious holidays
- Package pick-up (once per semester)

However, it is PUP policy that **no student who misses more than five classes, *even if the absences are excused*, will be able to pass the class.** Attendance will be taken at the beginning of every class. If an absence is excused, students need to submit the excuse *in writing* the day the next class day.

Students are responsible for catching up on material covered during classes they've missed, and for completing all assignments. Unexcused absences count against student participation and automatically drop students one third of a letter grade (for example, from a B+ to a B).

Plagiarism and Academic Integrity

The representation of another author's work as your own, whether that author is a fellow student or an author whose text we read, constitutes plagiarism and is a violation of scholarly ethics and the honor code of the Prison University Project and Patten University. Plagiarism is in essence stealing, and is

a serious offense. The consequences can be as severe as receiving a failing grade for an assignment, or for the course as a whole.

It is easy to accidentally plagiarize if you don't know or understand the rules for quoting, summarizing, paraphrasing and citing sources. It is the job the instructors for this course to help you learn those rules, but it is your job to actively seek assistance in learning how to cite, and to abide by the rules you've learned. If you have any doubts or questions about this policy and citation practices, please feel free to consult us.

Study Hall and Tutoring

We encourage you to attend study hall and take advantage of the tutoring services offered there. This course will demand a lot of your reading and writing skills. We expect that students are able to construct proper sentences and paragraphs, and to develop coherent theses and arguments. If you feel you have not mastered these writing and grammar skills yet, or if we point out you could use further work on this front, please make sure you attend study hall. For all students, study hall presents a great opportunity to improve your writing and argumentation.

Course Readings

There are no required texts for the course. Instead, students will be given handouts with a selection of photocopied readings in class. Readings may be updated as the course progresses. Note that **all readings for a given class must be read *before* that day.**

Course Schedule

PART I: THE PRE-COLONIAL AND COLONIAL WORLDS

WEEK 1

1. FRIDAY (January 24) — INTRODUCTION AND OVERVIEW

In Class:

- Discussion of syllabus, course objectives, themes and requirements.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 4

2. SUNDAY (January 26) — PRE-COLONIAL AMERICA

Readings:

- Mann, Charles (2006). *1491: New Revelations of the Americas Before Columbus*, selections.
- Eakin, Marshall C (2007). *The History of Latin America: Collision of Cultures*, chpts 1 and 2.
- “The Mayan Origin Myth” in *Keen’s Latin American Civilization*.
- “How the Inca Formed a Nation” in *Keen’s Latin American Civilization*.

In Class:

- Assign map quiz.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 3, 4, 8

WEEK 2

3. FRIDAY (January 31) — GEOGRAPHY OF THE “NEW WORLD” AND THE IDEA OF “LATIN AMERICA”

Readings:

- Skidmore, Thomas and Peter Smith (2001). "Why Latin America?" *Modern Latin America*. Prologue.
- *Our Americas: Political and Cultural Imaginings*. A special issue of: *Radical History Review*. Introduction.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

4. SUNDAY (February 2) — CONTACTS, ENCOUNTERS, AND CONQUEST

Readings:

- Chasteen, John Charles (2011). *Born in Blood and Fire: A Concise History of Latin America*, chpt 1.
- Restall, Matthew (2003). “The Indians Are Coming to an End.” *Seven Myths of the Spanish Conquest*. Chpt 6.
- De Las Casas. *A Short Account of the Destruction of the Indies*, selections.
- Diaz, Bernal. “The Halls of Moctezuma” in *Keen’s Latin American Civilization*.

In Class:

- **Quiz:** Map Quiz

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 3, 8

WEEK 3

5. FRIDAY (February 7) — COLONIAL SOCIETY AND CULTURE

Readings:

- Martinez, Maria Elena (2009). “The Language, Genealogy, and Classification of ‘Race’ in Colonial Mexico.” *Race and Classification: The Case of Mexican America*. Ed. Ilona Katzew and Susan Deans-Smith.
- Mugaburu y Honton, Josephe de. “Diary of Colonial Lima.” *The Peru Reader*.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

6. SUNDAY (February 9) — THE COLONIAL ECONOMY

Readings:

- Bakewell, Peter (2009). *A History of Latin America to 1825*, pgs 225-257.
- Acosta. “The Potosi Mine” in *Keen’s Latin American Civilization*.
- Acosta. “Spain’s Contribution to New World Agriculture” in *Keen’s Latin American Civilization*.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

PART II: REVOLUTION, INDEPENDENCE AND NEW NATIONS

WEEK 4

7. FRIDAY (February 14) — THE ROADS TO REVOLUTION

Readings:

- Maxwell, Kenneth (1973). *Conflicts and Conspiracies: Brazil and Portugal, 1750-1808*. Chpt. 5.
- Halperin Donghi, Tulio. “The Revolution” in *The Argentine Reader*.

In Class:

- Assign Short Essay 1: Take-Home Midterm on the Colonial Period.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

8. SUNDAY (February 16) — THE HAITIAN REVOLUTION

Readings:

- Dubois, Laurent (2005). *Avengers of the New World: The Story of the Haitian Revolution*, selections.
- Moreau de Saint-Mery. "The Freedmen."
- *Declaration of the Rights of Man and the Citizen*.
- (1801). *Haitian Constitution*.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

WEEK 5

9. FRIDAY (February 21) — REBELLION, REVOLUTION AND INDEPENDENCE

Readings:

- Bolivar, Simon. "The Jamaica Letter."
- San Martín, José de. "The Good Citizen."
- Earle, Rebecca (2001). "Creole Patriotism and the Myth of the 'Loyal Indian.'"
- Pedro I. "Declaration of Brazilian Independence."
- Skidmore and Smith (2001). "The Roots of Independence."

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

10. SUNDAY (February 23) — THE POLITICS OF NEW NATIONS: ENDEAVORING ORDER

Readings:

- Loveman, Brian (1999). "Inventing La Patria: Wars, Caudillismo, and Politics, 1810-1885" in *For La Patria: Politics and the Armed Forces in Latin America*.
- Mallon, Florencia (1995). "Political History from Below" in *Peasant and Nation: The Making of Post-Colonial Mexico and Peru*.
- (1853). *Constitution of the Argentine Nation*.
- Bilbao, Francisco. "The Age of Violence" in *Keen's Latin American Civilization*.

In Class:

- **DUE:** Short Essay 1: Take-Home Midterm on the Colonial Period.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 7, 8

WEEK 6

11. FRIDAY (February 28) — THE SOCIETY AND CULTURE OF NEW NATIONS: CONTRADICTIONS OF MODERNITY AND MODERNIZATION

Readings:

- Sarmiento, Domingo F. *Facundo: Or, Civilization and Barbarism*, selections.
- Alberdi, Juan Bautista. "Immigration as a Means of Progress."
- Scobie, James. "The Paris of South America."
- Schwarcz, Lilia Moritz (2006). "A Mestizo and Tropical Country: The Creation of the Official Image of Brazil."

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

12. SUNDAY (March 2) — IN SEARCH OF PROGRESS AND PROSPERITY

Readings:

- Chasteen, John Charles (2011). *Born in Blood and Fire: A Concise History of Latin America*, pgs 149-176.
- Skidmore, Thomas E. and Peter H. Smith (2001). *Modern Latin America*, pgs 36-47.
- Alberdi, Juan Bautista. "Roads to the Future" in *Keen's Latin American Civilization*.
- Vargas, Fernando Silva. "A Different Model of Economic Development: A New Program for Chile" in *Keen's Latin American Civilization*.

In Class:

- **Returned:** Short Essay 1 graded.
- Assign Short Essay 2: Analysis of a Primary Source.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 5, 8

PART III: INTERNAL STRUGGLES AND EXTERNAL FORCES

WEEK 7

13. FRIDAY (March 7) — SLAVERY AND ABOLITION

Readings:

- Knight, Franklin (1970). "The Legal Framework of Cuban Slavery." *Slave Society in Cuba during the 19th Century*. Chpt. 6
- "Slavery and its Aftermath" in *the Brazil Reader*.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

14. SUNDAY (March 9) — THE MEXICAN REVOLUTION

Readings:

- Jaffary, Nora E., Edward Osowski and Susan S. Porter, eds (2010). *Mexican History: A Primary Source Reader*, selections.
- Hernandez Chavez, Alicia (2006). *Mexico: A Brief History*, chpts 9 and 10.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

WEEK 8

15. FRIDAY (March 14) — US-LATIN AMERICA RELATIONS: FROM THE MONROE DOCTRINE TO THE ALLIANCE FOR PROGRESS

Readings:

- Marti, Jose. "Our America."
- The Monroe Doctrine.
- Sadlier, Denise (2008). "Good Neighbor Brazil." *Brazil Imagined*. Chpt. 6
- Alliance for Progress.
- Skidmore and Smith (2001). "Latin America, the United States, and the World," Chpt. 11

In Class:

- **DUE:** Short Essay 2: Analysis of a Primary Document.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 5, 8

16. SUNDAY (March 16) — CONSOLIDATING THE NATION-STATE

Readings:

- Chasteen, John Charles (2011). *Born in Blood and Fire: A Concise History of Latin America*, chpt 7.
- Meade, Teresa A. (2010). *A History of Modern Latin America: 1800 to the Present*, pgs 136-142.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

WEEK 9

17. FRIDAY (March 21) — POPULISM

Readings:

- "The Vargas Era" in *the Brazil Reader*, selections.
- Haya de la Torre. "The APRA."
- James, Daniel. "Peron and the People." *The Argentine Reader*.
- Krauze, Enrique (2011). "Eva Peron: The Madonna of the Shirtless Ones." *Redeemers: Ideas*

and Power in Latin America.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

18. SUNDAY (March 23) — THE DIRTY WARS: CHILE, ARGENTINA AND NICARAGUA

Readings:

- Wright, Thomas C (2007). *State Terrorism in Latin America: Chile, Argentina and International Human Rights*, selections.
- Skidmore, Thomas E. and Peter H. Smith (2001). "Nicaragua: From Dynasty to Revolution" in *Modern Latin America*, pgs 333-340.
- Declaration of the Chamber of Deputies. "Prelude to Dictatorship" in *Keen's Latin American Civilization*.
- Kissinger, Henry A. (1970). "Memorandum for the President. Subject: Chile."
- Allende, Salvador (1973). "Last Words to the Nation."
- Fisher, Jo. "Mothers of the Disappeared" in *Keen's Latin American Civilization*.

In Class:

- Assign Final Paper.
- Outlining, free writing, and brainstorming for the final paper.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 6, 7, 8

WEEK 10

19. FRIDAY (March 28) — THE CUBAN REVOLUTION

Readings:

- Farber, Samuel (2006). Introduction and "Fidel Castro and the Cuban Populist Tradition." *The Origins of the Cuban Revolution Reconsidered*.
- Castro, Fidel (1953). "History Will Absolve Me."

In Class:

- **Returned:** Short Essay 2 graded.
- Additional outlining, free writing, and brainstorming for the final paper.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 6, 7, 8

20. SUNDAY (March 30) — DEMOCRACY AND AUTHORITARIANISM

Readings:

- Fowler, William M. (1996). *Authoritarianism in Latin America Since Independence*, selections.
- Dominguez, Jorge (1998). *Democratic Politics in Latin America and the Caribbean*, selections.
- Stepan, Alfred (1973). *Authoritarian Brazil: Origins, Policies, and Future*, selections.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

WEEK 11

21. FRIDAY (April 4) — DICTATORSHIP, EXILE, AND RESISTANCE

Readings:

- Perlongher, Nestor. “Corpses.” *The Argentine Reader*.
- Mercado, Tununa. “In a State of Memory.” *The Argentine Reader*.
- National Commission on the Disappearance of Persons. “Never Again.” *The Argentine Reader*.
- Dunn, Christopher. “Tropicalism and Brazilian Popular Music under Military Rule.” *The Brazil Reader*.
- Dorfman, Ariel (2011). *Feeding on Dreams: Confessions of an Unrepentant Exile*, selections.

In Class:

- **DUE:** Final Paper rough draft.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

22. SUNDAY (April 6) — NEOLIBERALISM AND ITS DISCONTENTS

Readings:

- Ocampo, Jose Antonio and Jaime Ros (2011). “Shifting Paradigms in Latin America’s Economic Development” in *Latin America Handbook*.
- Blustein, Paul (2003). *The Chastening: Inside the Crisis That Rocked the Global Financial System and Humbled the IMF*, selections.
- Thorpe, Rosemary (1998). *Progress, Poverty and Exclusion*, selections.
- Prebisch, Raul. “Dependence” in *Keen’s Latin American Civilization*.
- Da Silva, Luiz Ignacio Lula. “Lula Speaks Out” in *Keen’s Latin American Civilization*.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8

PART IV: CONTEMPORARY LATIN AMERICA

WEEK 12

23. FRIDAY (April 11) — IMMIGRATION AND THE LATINO DIASPORA

- Degrigori, Carlos Ivan. “Chayraq.” *The Peru Reader*.
- Monsivais, Carlos. “North American Culture and Mexico.” *The Latin American Cultural Studies Reader*.
- Flores, Juan. “The Latino Imaginary.” *The Latin American Cultural Studies Reader*.
- Lesser, Jeffrey. “Immigrant Ethnicity in Brazil.” *The Brazil Reader*.

In Class:

- **Returned:** Final paper rough draft graded.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 7, 8

24. SUNDAY (April 13) — IN-CLASS PRESENTATIONS

In Class:

- Final paper presentations.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 8

WEEK 13

25. FRIDAY (April 18) — IN-CLASS PRESENTATIONS

In Class:

- Final paper presentations.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 9

26. SUNDAY (April 20) — CONTEMPORARY CHALLENGES: POVERTY AND VIOLENCE

Readings:

- Mehta, Suketu (2013). “In the Violent Favelas of Brazil.” *The New York Review of Books*.
- Rosenberg, Tina (2008). “A Payoff Out of Poverty?” *The New York Times*.
- Desmond Arias, Enrique (2010). “Conclusion” in *Violent Democracies in Latin America*, Enrique Desmond Arias and Daniel M. Goldstein, eds.

In Class:

- **DUE:** Final Paper.
- Final wrap up.

Progress on Course Objectives Number: 1, 2, 8